

SERI NEGARA DIALOGUE

Website Developer Brief — Phase 1

Event: Seri Negara Dialogue 2026

Date: 8 October 2026

Venue: Muzium Negara, Kuala Lumpur

Convened by: Chevening Alumni Malaysia

1. OBJECTIVE

We require a professional website for the inaugural **Seri Negara Dialogue 2026**.

Our priorities are:

Quick to launch | Low cost | Visually impressive | Easy to use | Easy to maintain

The website should establish Seri Negara Dialogue as a **credible, contemporary and inclusive Malaysian platform for national conversation**.

Although the immediate priority is the 2026 event, the website should be capable of growing with future annual editions without requiring a complete rebuild.

Development approach

Keep Phase 1 simple. Use proven solutions. Avoid unnecessary custom development.

2. PLATFORM

Use **WordPress**, with a reliable lightweight theme and established plugins.

The developer should:

- minimise custom coding;
- use free or reasonably priced plugins where practical;
- keep recurring costs low;
- ensure good mobile performance; and
- allow the organising team to make routine content updates independently.

No bespoke system is required for Phase 1.

3. LANGUAGES

The website should offer:

Bahasa Malaysia | English | 中文 | தமிழ்

Primary languages

Bahasa Malaysia and English

These will contain reviewed and approved content.

Chinese and Tamil

These may initially use a suitable WordPress automatic translation plugin.

The solution should be affordable, easy to maintain and allow important translations to be manually corrected where practical.

The four-language requirement should not delay the website launch.

4. DESIGN DIRECTION

The website should look **high-quality despite being simple to build.**

Desired character:

Malaysian | Contemporary | Inclusive | Intelligent | Institutional | Premium

The impact should come from:

- strong typography;
- excellent photography;
- professional speaker portraits;
- generous spacing;
- clean layouts;
- restrained use of colour; and
- concise content.

Avoid:

- generic conference appearance;
- excessive text;
- clutter;
- unnecessary animation;

- countdown timers;
- complicated effects; and
- political-party or community-specific visual cues.

The website should feel like the beginning of a **serious national institution**, rather than a one-off event website.

5. WEBSITE STRUCTURE

Keep Phase 1 simple:

Home | About | Speakers | Programme | RSVP

Language selector:

BM | EN | 中文 | தமிழ்

Avoid creating unnecessary pages.

Most important information should also be accessible directly from the homepage.

6. HOMEPAGE

The homepage is the most important part of the website.

A visitor should immediately understand:

What is this? | Why does it matter? | Who is participating? | When and where? | How do I attend?

Hero

SERI NEGARA DIALOGUE 2026

A National Conversation on Malaysia's Future

8 October 2026

Muzium Negara, Kuala Lumpur

2.30 PM onwards

Primary CTA:

REGISTER / RSVP

Use a strong, elegant hero visual.

No countdown timer is required.

Homepage Content

The homepage should then flow naturally through:

01 — About the Dialogue

A short introduction explaining its purpose and long-term ambition.

02 — 2026 Theme

A concise presentation of the inaugural theme and key questions.

03 — Welcome from the Organising Chairman

Professional photograph, name, designation and concise welcome message.

04 — Speakers & Moderator

Strong portraits, names, titles and organisations.

05 — Programme

Simple event timeline.

06 — Event Information

Date, time, venue and Google Maps/directions.

07 — RSVP

A strong final registration call-to-action.

The homepage should tell the story without requiring visitors to navigate extensively.

7. SPEAKERS

Create a visually strong but simple Speakers section/page.

Each speaker should have:

- professional photograph;
- full name;
- designation;
- organisation;
- short biography; and
- relevant official external link.

The moderator should be presented similarly.

Individual speaker webpages are not required for Phase 1.

Speaker information should be editable through WordPress.

8. PROGRAMME

Present the programme as a clean, mobile-friendly timeline.

The organising team must be able to update timings and programme information directly through WordPress.

No complicated programme functionality is required.

9. RSVP / REGISTRATION

Registration is an **essential Phase 1 function**.

Use an established WordPress form or event-registration plugin rather than custom development.

Keep the registration process short and mobile-friendly.

Required information should be limited to what is genuinely necessary, such as:

- Full Name
- Email
- Mobile Number
- Organisation
- Designation
- Dietary requirement, if required
- Privacy/PDPA acknowledgement

The system should provide:

- automated confirmation;
- participant list/database;
- registration capacity control; and
- CSV/Excel export.

QR Ticketing

QR ticket/check-in may be included **only if easily available through the selected plugin at little or no additional cost**.

It is not a launch requirement.

The estimated event capacity is approximately **200 participants**.

10. QUICK LINKS

Include relevant official external links naturally within the website or footer.

These may include:

- Ministry of National Unity;
- Muzium Negara / Jabatan Muzium Malaysia;
- British High Commission Kuala Lumpur;
- Chevening;
- speakers' organisations; and
- moderator's organisation.

Links should open in a new tab.

Organisations should only be described as **partners, supporters or sponsors** where this status has been formally confirmed.

Otherwise, use neutral descriptions or simply provide the relevant link.

11. MOBILE & SOCIAL SHARING

The website must work particularly well on mobile.

Many visitors are expected to arrive through:

WhatsApp | Email | Facebook | LinkedIn | QR codes

The mobile journey should therefore be:

Understand → Explore → Register

The RSVP button should be highly visible.

The website must also display professionally when shared on WhatsApp, Facebook and LinkedIn, with an appropriate image, title and description.

12. ESSENTIAL TECHNICAL REQUIREMENTS

Keep technical implementation straightforward.

Phase 1 requires:

- WordPress CMS;
- responsive/mobile-first design;
- SSL/HTTPS;
- reliable hosting;
- basic security;
- automated backup;
- spam protection;
- image optimisation;
- good loading speed;
- basic SEO;
- social-sharing metadata;
- basic website analytics;
- privacy/PDPA considerations; and
- registration data export.

Avoid unnecessary premium plugins and subscriptions.

13. FUTURE GROWTH

Seri Negara Dialogue is intended to continue beyond 2026.

The website should therefore allow future annual editions to be added, for example:

2026 | 2027 | 2028

After the inaugural event, the website can progressively add:

- photographs;
- videos;
- reports;
- media coverage;
- publications;
- previous Dialogues; and
- future initiatives.

More advanced features can be introduced only when there is a clear need.

These are NOT Phase 1 requirements.

The developer simply needs to ensure that the initial WordPress structure can be expanded later.

14. COST & DEVELOPMENT CONTROL

The developer should work on a **lean Phase 1 / MVP basis**.

The quotation should clearly separate:

A. Phase 1 Development

Fixed one-off cost

B. Annual Recurring Costs

Including only:

- domain;
- hosting;
- essential plugin licences; and
- translation plugin/service, if applicable.

C. Optional Future Enhancements

Quoted separately and implemented only if subsequently approved.

The developer should highlight any paid plugin or recurring subscription before implementation.

No unnecessary custom development or recurring subscriptions should be introduced.

15. OWNERSHIP & HANDOVER

The organising entity should retain full ownership and administrative access to:

- domain;
- hosting;
- WordPress;
- website files;
- database;
- analytics;
- registration data; and
- relevant plugin accounts/licences.

At handover, provide:

- administrator credentials;
- list of plugins used;

- list of recurring costs; and
- simple instructions for updating the website.

Routine website updates should not require developer involvement.

PHASE 1 SUCCESS CRITERIA

The website does not need to do everything.

For the inaugural launch, success means:

- 1. It can be launched quickly.**
- 2. It looks impressive, credible and professional.**
- 3. Visitors immediately understand Seri Negara Dialogue.**
- 4. Registration is simple and reliable.**
- 5. Development and recurring costs remain low.**
- 6. The website can grow after 2026 without being rebuilt.**

Launch lean. Create impact. Build progressively.